

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Equivalent expressions	Easy

Question

Which expression is equivalent to $17(x^2 - 100y^2)$?

Answer

- A. $17(x - 2y)(x - 50y)$
- B. $17(x - 2y)(x + 50y)$
- C. $17(x - 10y)(x - 10y)$
- D. $17(x - 10y)(x + 10y)$

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. Expressions in the form $a^2 - b^2$ follow the difference of two squares pattern and can be factored as $(a - b)(a + b)$. In the given expression, $17(x^2 - 100y^2)$, the expression $x^2 - 100y^2$ follows the difference of two squares pattern. It follows that the expression $x^2 - 100y^2$ can be rewritten as $(x - 10y)(x + 10y)$. Therefore, the expression $17(x - 10y)(x + 10y)$ is equivalent to $17(x^2 - 100y^2)$.

Choice A is incorrect. This expression is equivalent to $17(x^2 - 52xy + 100y^2)$, not $17(x^2 - 100y^2)$.

Choice B is incorrect. This expression is equivalent to $17(x^2 + 48xy - 100y^2)$, not $17(x^2 - 100y^2)$.

Choice C is incorrect. This expression is equivalent to $17(x^2 - 20xy + 100y^2)$, not $17(x^2 - 100y^2)$.